Special Operations Brigade Platoon Leader Planning Handout

Written by CFS-0713/80 “Sparrow”



Purpose and Intent

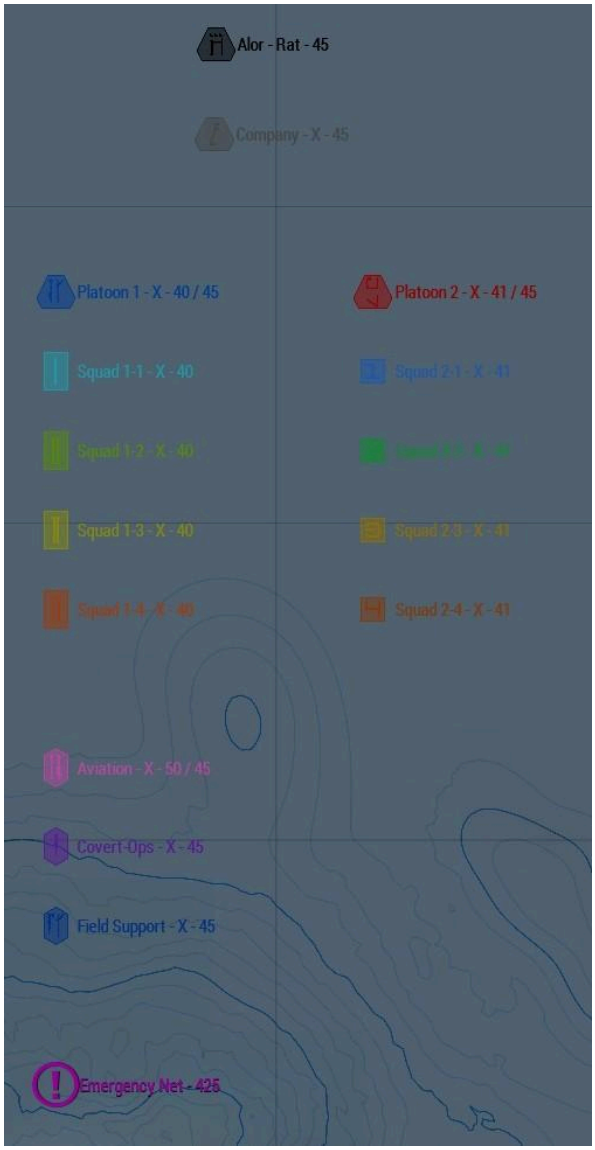
The purpose of this handout is to provide Platoon Leaders with guidance on effective planning practices and to outline their responsibilities during operational execution. The examples contained herein are intended to serve as reference tools to assist Platoon Leaders in the development of objectives for their platoon and the effective coordination and employment of their squads.

Pre-Stepoff Procedures

Your Company leadership will designate the load-in time for platoon leaders, most commonly once they have sent a Discord Ping for load in.

Once this has occurred your priority is to grab a kit from the arsenal and proceed directly to your Zeus/Company Pre-brief. During this time it is recommended to do the following:

1. Set your Long Range and Short Range Radios
2. Update your Platoon Command marker on the top right of your Map as shown in the example below
3. Update your ACE Team Management name through your ACE Self-Interact.



Ex. **Callsign - Lead - LR Radio -> Alor - Rat - 45**

https://imgur.com/a/vM4XIHP

Zeus Brief

Zeus will initiate the Operation briefing explaining what the purpose of the operation is as a whole, and ask any questions you may have about the operation itself during that time.

Company Brief

Post Zeus briefing your Company element will finalize the company level plan and Platoon Areas of Operation based off of the previously provided OPORD located in the discord(ex. friday-planning), so communicate any questions or concerns about the planning portion during this phase.

Platoon Brief

Once the Zeus/Company Pre-Brief has concluded you will radio to your platoon to meet you in an established Platoon Briefing Area(if one is not present you will choose a location). Once you have done so, remind your platoon to update their ACE Team Management as well as their Squad Designations on the Top Right of the Map. Following this you will do the following:

1. Send your needed Reservist count to your Company CO/XO via LR 45 or via CTAB
2. Brief your Squads on the information provided during the Company Pre-brief and your platoons Primary and Secondary objectives
3. Begin to Mark and plan your objectives in your AO(s)
4. Manage the Platoon Loadout Composition, ensure each squad's kits make sense for the operation(ex. Not enough AT Troopers when it is expected to see Heavy OPFOR Armored presence).
5. Ensure all Medics are communicating on Medical Short Range frequency 425
6. Coordinate initial insert into your AO

Expectations for Platoon Leadership

The Platoon Leadership element consists of both Commanding Officer(CO) and Executive Officer(XO), you are a team and all the following responsibilities fall on you to ensure success. Your CO will manage LR 45 and XO will manage LR 46. A Leadership team is only as effective as your abilities to assist each other in tasks, if one is overburdened with Long Range comms you may need to pick up their slack with directing the platoon or vice-versa. A leadership team should eventually ,with practice, grow to develop a non-verbal understanding of where they need to step in to assist the other.

1. Coordinate with Company Command over LR 45 to execute any orders they made pass down, to inform them of any changes or intelligence in operation, and the status of your Platoon.

2. Communicate with Support Detachments over LR 46 to coordinate extracts, RTBs, and other support as needed.
3. Maintain effective command and control of your Platoon, this includes frequent communication with your Squad Leaders to ensure they are remaining on task and to stay informed with the status of your Platoons health and equipment.
4. Develop contingencies to ensure flexibility within your element.
5. Ensure Squad Leaders are aware of your Platoon's step up procedures in the event you are incapacitated.
6. Platoon leadership should encompass a Macro/Micromanagement of their element to ensure a long-term and short-term tasking at all times. Knowing when to Micro vs Macro manage is important, it is the difference between giving Squad Leaders the freedom to be adaptive and creative in solving problems and having to remind people constantly to watch their spacing to prevent MASSCAS scenarios.

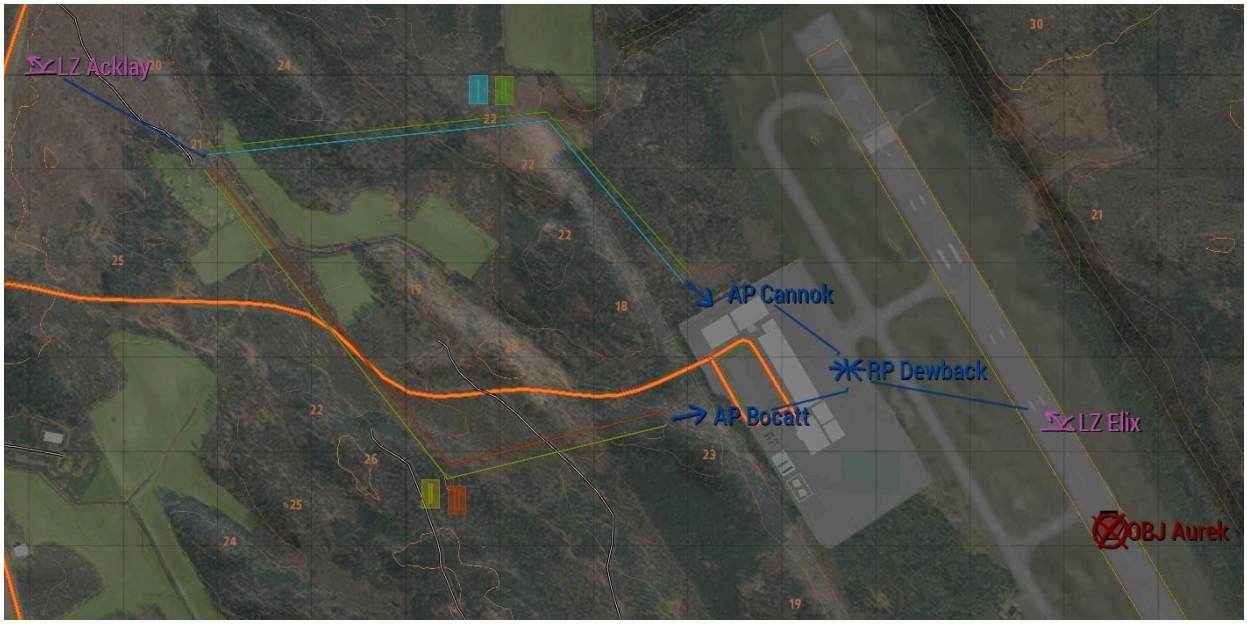
Macromanagement is a hands-off, strategic leadership style that focuses on high-level goals and outcomes rather than short term tasks, fostering autonomy and trust.

Micromanagement is a controlling leadership style characterized by excessive supervision, obsession with minor details, and a reluctance to delegate, which stifles autonomy, and creativity.

"No plan survives first contact with the enemy"

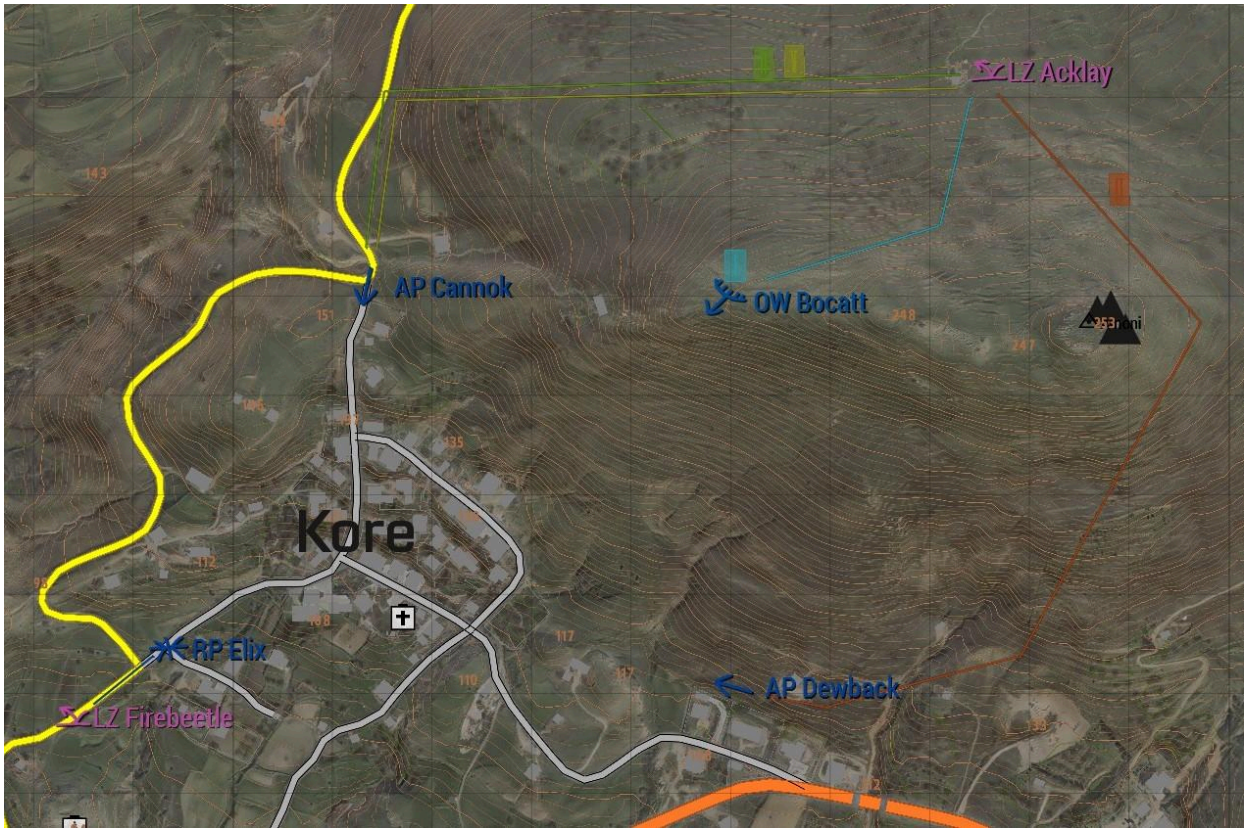
Planning Examples:

https://imgur.com/62ljZTk



This example shows a Pincer Formation with a Lead force of two squads(phase lines show their respective squad markers) assaulting the main building in the objective reflected by the Attack Point Cannok while the other Supporting force with the remaining two squads flank from Attack Point Bocatt, this is a simple way to separately task your squads and force them to coordinate with each other on approach to an objective. This also features a Rendezvous Point to meet up after the initial assault.

https://imgur.com/LmUFImh



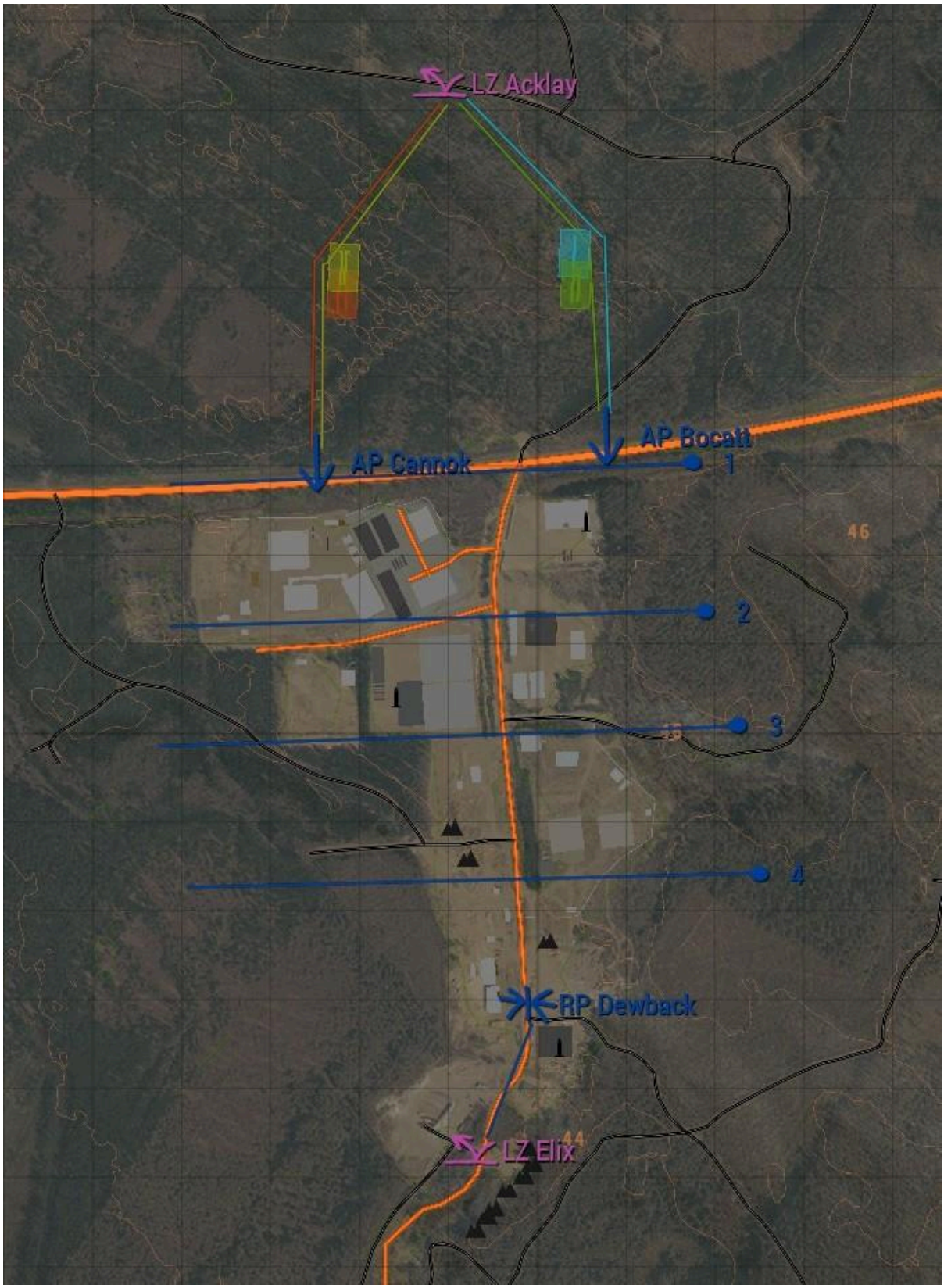
This Example shows two Squads approaching from the Main Road in the region to Attack this Objective at Attack Point Cannok, while this squad is moving to their attack point another squad is moving to Attack Point Dewback to flank the objective from another direction. While the majority of the Platoon is preparing to attack we have the final squad at Overwatch Bocatt to provide early recon for the platoon and then provide support from an elevated position as directed from the Platoon Leads.

https://imgur.com/harm3nl



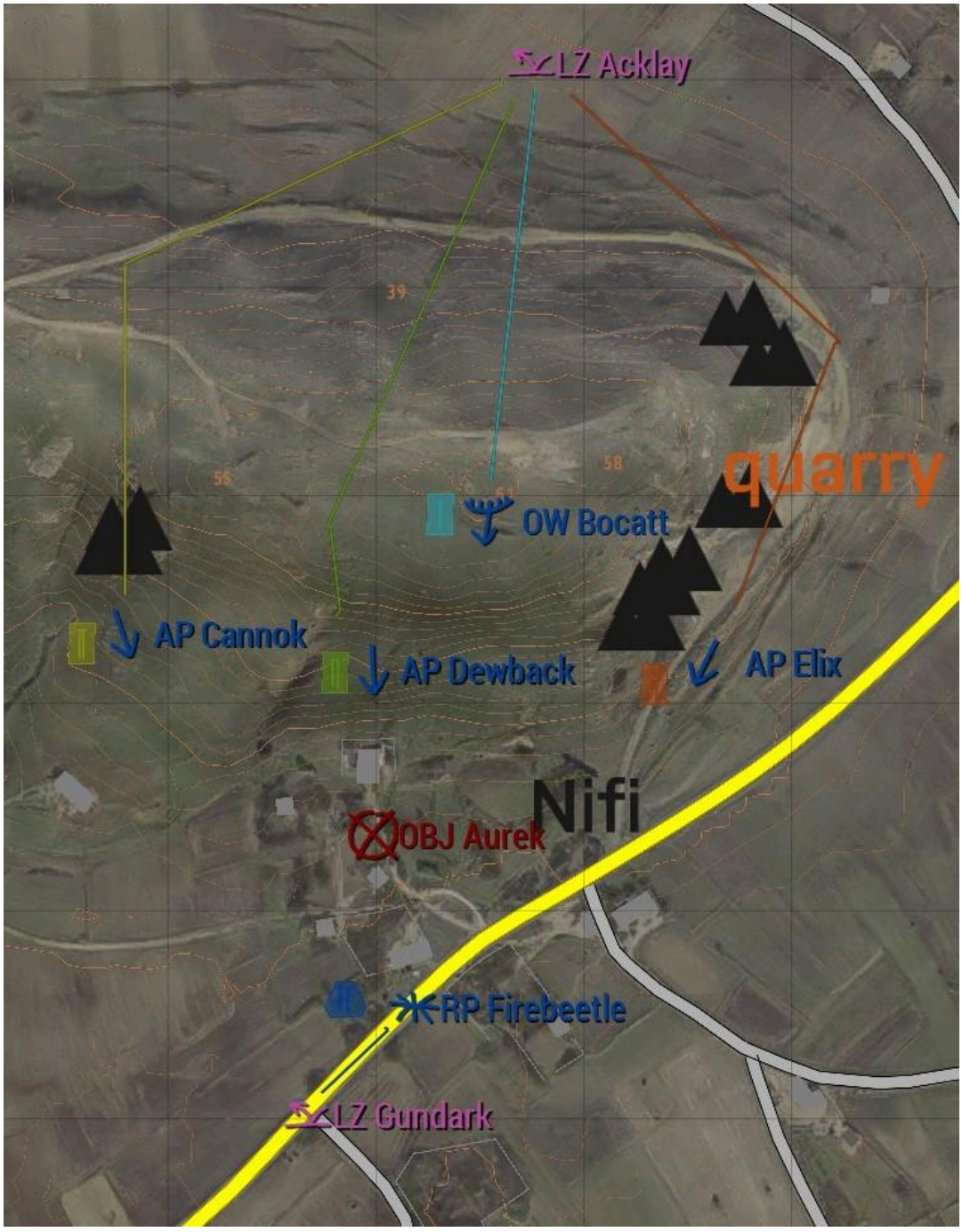
This example is a very simple plan for either a Squad sized objective or for the entire Platoon to assault an Objective. It features a Drop Zone for the insert, an Overwatch to gather intel via Reconnaissance, and closes with an Attack Point for the Squad/Platoon to clean out the Objective itself before extracting at Landing Zone Dewback.

https://imgur.com/xogBTSx



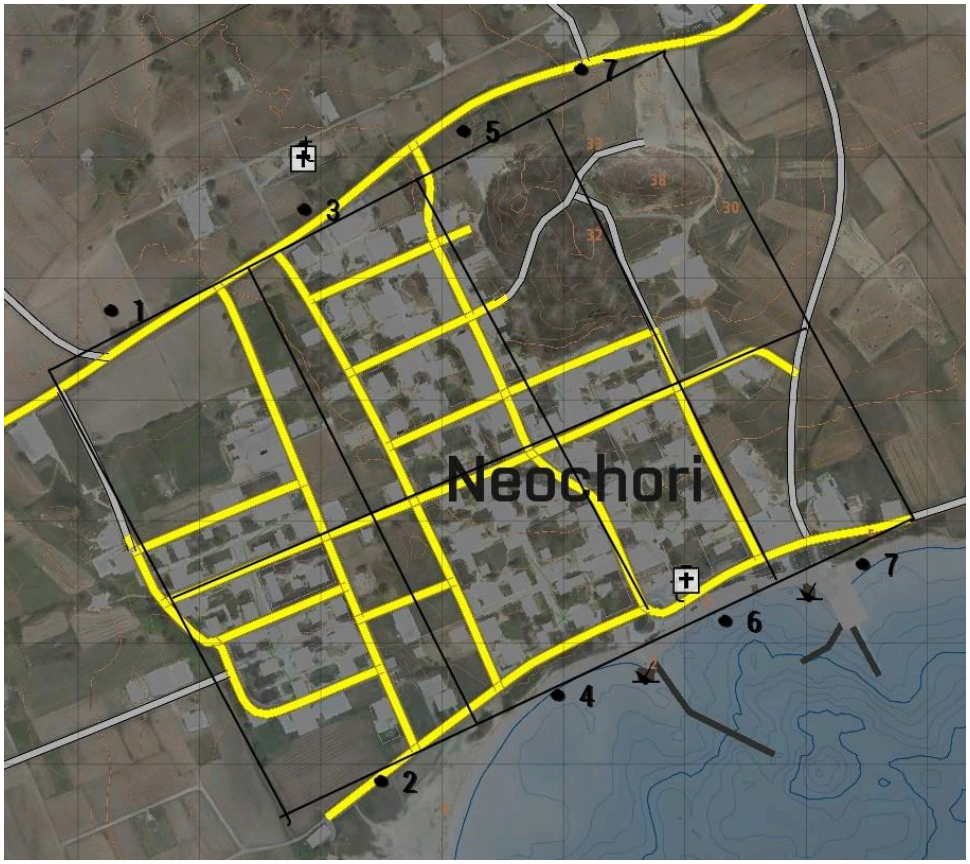
This example shows multiple phase lines showing not only where squads will transit to their attack points but additionally where they will hold until designated by the Platoon Leader to continue, this allows for all Squads to remain in supporting distance to each other and for no 1 Squad to get ahead of any other. It slows down the Platoon and gives everyone the opportunity to be slow and methodical while also being able to use it as a defensive line if met with heavy resistance.

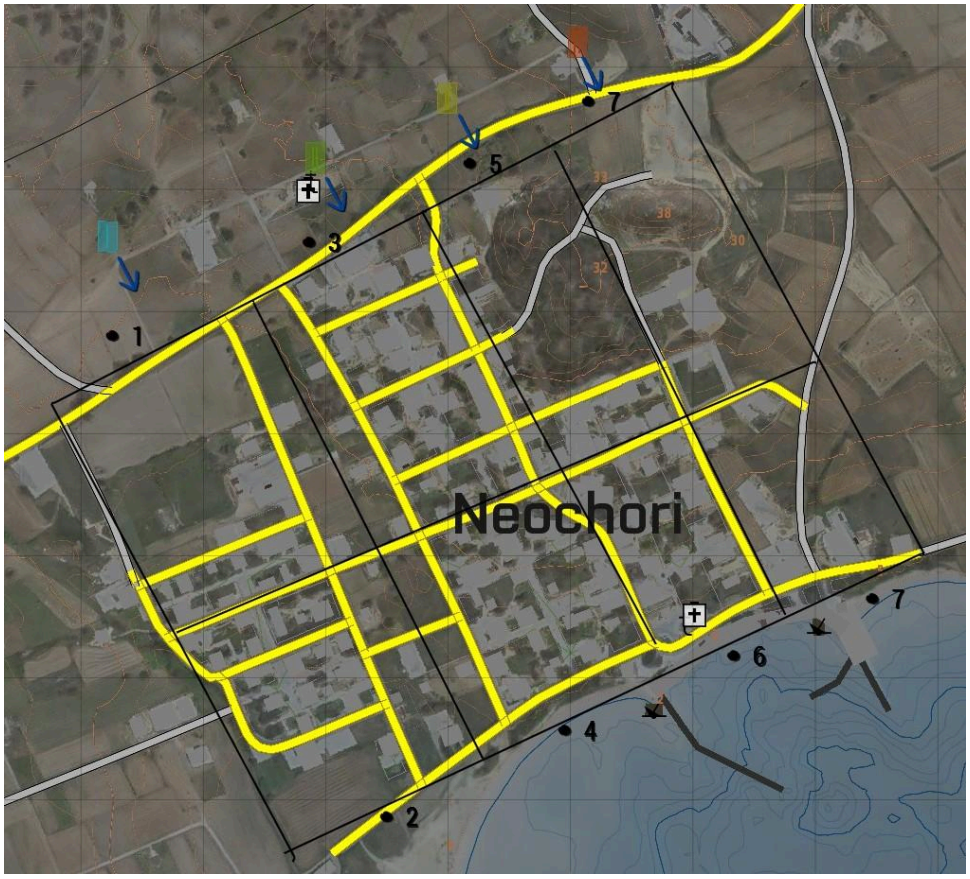
https://imgur.com/5Q9SJzS



This example uses all squads independently to assault an objective at once, each squad has their own attack point to assault from, while simultaneously having a final squad providing constant overwatch from an elevated position. This is good because it divides up the squads enough on approach so that if the town is more fortified in one area over the others the squads can remain flexible and readjust as needed and it doesn't put the entire force at risk with a single Attack Point approach.

https://imgur.com/KRm5PM5
https://imgur.com/zlWYOMv


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These two examples show ways to mark off objectives into sectors for an assault, the first example can be used simply to assign sectors to certain squads during the assault, while the second example shows a preplanned assault from the north giving each squad their own column of sectors to assault. This is an easy way of giving a clear and defined task for your squads to fulfill in an objective.

How to Plan

The following are tools you can utilize to plan out your Area of Operations as has been shown in the examples above.

The link below shows Marker Naming schemes utilized by SOB, Objectives utilize Aurebesh most commonly while regular Map Markers can be things like Creatures, Wood, Minerals, Police Phonetic Alphabet, or Fruits. You don't want your Map Naming scheme to overlap with that of another platoon. You want all of your Map markers to be in alphabetical order and not hop between naming schemes, if you go alphabetically from your first objective to

the last it helps people see the path the platoon is intending to take.

Map Marker Cheat Sheet

In ex.1 you will see some of the most common DRAWN MILITARY markers used during operations

1. Objective = OBJ (Objective)
2. Flag = FOB(Forward Operating Base) or HQ(Headquarters)
3. Arrow = Direction of Approach or AP (Attack Point)
4. Ambush = OW (Overwatch)
5. Destroy = FM (Fire Mission)
6. Start = Not utilized commonly but could potentially be used to show Jump Trooper entry
7. End = DZ (Drop Zone)
8. Pick Up = LZ (Landing Zone)
9. Join = RP (Rendezvous/Rally Point)
10. Warning = Shows urgent or hostile POI
11. Unknown = POI (Point of Interest) Shows a potential point of interest
12. Dot = This can be utilized for Marking AO names (ex. AO Acklay), sectoring off objectives or to be a filler marker for planning purposes
13. Platoon Markers while not listed are another good marker to utilize for marking your Area of Operations or AOs



Ex. 1

https://imgur.com/hUOl0pQ

Below in Ex.2 and Ex.3 you can see the SOB Marker Colors, it is recommended to use your Platoon Color for the majority of your Platoon agnostic markings, for any LZ or DZ use [SOB] Aviation as your marker color. When using Squad Markers to show squad taskings utilize their respective Squad Color and Marker.



Ex. 2 and Ex. 3

https://imgur.com/oesVtZR

https://imgur.com/UkXwEQx